



Among the elite

Microsoft announces the Xbox One Elite Wireless Controller with elite features. Read more: <http://dgit.in/elitecntrlr>



Who needs sleep?

With the increasing number of drugs that help us to stay awake for longer, will the need to sleep be eliminated? Read more: <http://dgit.in/notosleep>

Budget laptops



Acer Aspire E15 E5-571-593D is a good overall budget laptop!

everyone in the competition only managed to pack in 4GB and 6GB of RAM, both the Acer Aspire E15 E5 571 and E15 E5 571G machines here came with a whopping 8GB of RAM built in – that's great for laptops selling at the 40k mark.

The two Acer laptops also have a well-arranged keyboard deck, with a dedicated number pad, and chiclet-keys that are nice to type on. However, using its single-slab touchpad isn't as great as the two HP laptops' who have the best touchpad experience across all the laptops we tested in this comparison. Both machines have almost the same screen brightness levels at 181 cd/m2 but their contrast ratios aren't anything to boast about, we're afraid. At 4 hours and 6 minutes, the Acer Aspire E5 571's battery performance is the best across all the budget laptops we tested this month, and with 3 hours 37 minutes the Aspire E5 571G does pretty well, too. However, battery performance only accounts for one-sixth of the total performance parameters in our test, and on most other fronts the Acer laptops don't do anything to make you sit up and take notice of their

prowess. Both 15-inch laptops are the most bulkiest off the bunch and carrying them anywhere is a chore. Multimedia experience on the Acer laptops is strictly okay. And the feature set on both the Acer Aspire laptops in this comparison are quite good, and all things considered they're great machines to consider if you're an Acer fan.

TWO HPS

Easily one of the most attractive laptops of the comparison, the two HP 15-AF001AX and HP 15 AC030TX have a textured screen lid with a dull silver finish which grabs eyeballs from a distance. And when you open them up, both laptops sport a glossy palmrest and surrounding keyboard deck with an attractive pattern like that of a plywood. Both machines are built well, just like the Acer laptops, but they're considerably lighter given their form factor, which makes them easier to carry around.

As far as features go, the HP 15-AF001AX is based on a quad-core AMD A8 APU, while the HP 15-AC030TX comes with an Intel Core i3 chip inside. Everything else

is exactly the same on both HP laptops, right from their external ports, weight, RAM, hard drive, even the presence of 2GB GDDR3 AMD Radeon R5 M330 graphics. However, the price disparity is quite big between the two machines – the AMD APU edition of the laptop is cheaper than its Intel counterpart by a whopping 8k!

While the Intel-equipped HP 15 laptop is overall the second best performer in this comparison, the AMD-powered HP 15 is close on its heel and ends up being third on the overall list, comfortably beating the two Acer and one Lenovo laptop in this test. Multitasking is much better on the two HP laptops, especially, when it comes to graphic-intensive work and you can even consider doing some lightweight gaming on them as well. The audio experience on the two HP laptops is also one of the better ones we experienced among all the laptops we reviewed for this comparison – even though laptop audio isn't great, overall, but the HP 15 laptops managed to perform better than most others.

As far as keyboard goes, there's nothing much to write home about, but the HP 15s

deserve special praise for its touchpad. These two laptops are the only ones in the comparison that come with a touchpad that has a dedicated left and mouse button – a fast disappearing trend. As a result, right or left clicking on the touchpad is the best experience we've had on a budget laptop in this test. Having said that, both these laptops don't have great screens when it comes to their contrast ratio which is the worst at 70:1 among all laptops we tested here. That's pretty much the only overwhelming negative in their case, apart from the HP 15-AC030TX's battery performance.

OF ASUS AND LENOVO

Where the ASUS offers great performance in a 15-inch form factor, the Lenovo is thin, slim, 14-inch budget ultraportable. Two very different laptops here with two very different use cases. Let's take a look at both of them separately.

The Lenovo U41-70 sports an attractive shell and is high on aesthetics, much like the two HP laptops we wrote about earlier. However, due to the Lenovo Y41's slim trim finish and anorexic dimensions – weighing



Acer Aspire E15 E5-571G-341R looks similar to the 571-593D